

The Build Workflow

Once code lives in git and a service knows how to become a tagged image, the only thing left is doing that automatically instead of by hand. That's `build.yml`.

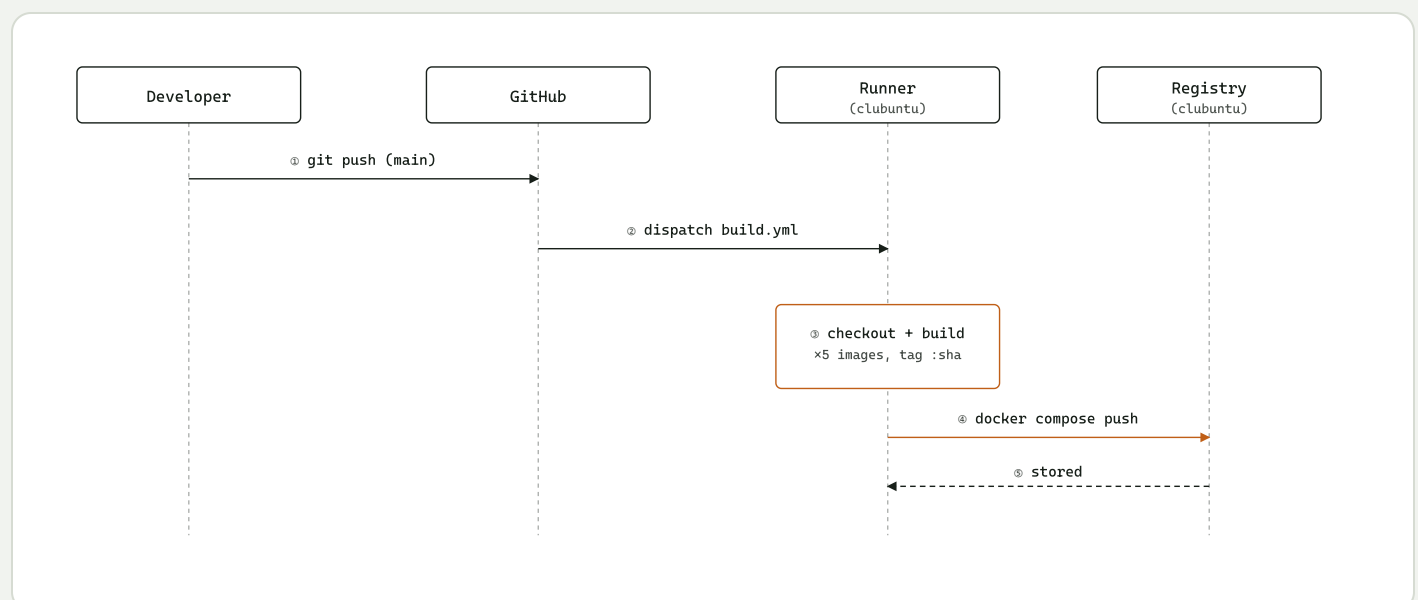
concept doc — no execution in this step 2026-08-16

01 Anatomy of a workflow file

Every GitHub Actions workflow is the same three-layer shape: a **trigger** (what starts it), a **job** (where it runs), and a list of **steps** (what it does, in order). `build.yml` uses all three, minimally.

- ▶ `on: push: branches: [main]` — trigger: every push to main
- ▶ `runs-on: [self-hosted, clubuntu]` — job: on the runner living on clubuntu (§05)
- ▶ steps: check out source, build, push

02 What happens, in order



This sequence never touches the running stack — it only stocks the registry. A commit can be built a dozen times without a single deployed container ever restarting.

03 The file

```
name: build
on:
  push:
    branches: [main]

jobs:
  build-and-push:
    runs-on: [self-hosted, clubuntu]
    steps:
      - uses: actions/checkout@v4
      - run: |
          export IMAGE_TAG=${GITHUB_SHA::7}
          docker compose build
          docker compose push
```

Note what's absent: no login step, no secret, no SSH target. The runner already sits on clubuntu, so `push` is a localhost call to the registry — see doc 5 for why that's true.